

zadeditd

Travel Radio Australia and we're here at the Horecava in Amsterdam. I'm here with a very special guest, the magnificent and the legendary Zad. Now Zad, you've been coming here to Horecava for many, many years and can you tell our overseas listeners, especially in Australia, what it's all about? Hello, hello, here's Zad from Amsterdam City.

We're here indeed at the convention Horecava. It's a hospitality convention. It's about drinks and food, music, lights, everything for bars and restaurants and having fun to entertain the people and themselves in the hospitality industry.

Now, people come to this event, this hospitality event, which is called Horecava, which is H-O-R-E-C-A-V-A. Horecava, Hotel Restaurant Café, it stands for, very Dutch to make that kind of short, like Horecava, Hotel Restaurant Café. So you find here all branches, all kinds of companies like hotel companies, food industry, even, you know, packing foods or takeout foods and bars, restaurants, everything, all of it is here for over, I do it myself over 35 years.

So as long as I remember, we were going here every year for free drinking, of course, that's a part of it. You're being invited, you sold a lot of beer for the breweries, they get you a couple of beers for you and your colleagues and your friends, and you can do some snacking around, walking around, getting a little food, all kinds of cuisines from French, Asian, Dutch, meat, vegetarian meat, whatever, it's all available here. Pretty good.

Yeah, it's a four-day event and over the four days they get like 50,000 people here. It's huge. I wasn't aware of that.

I thought it was more, but 50,000, that's a lot of hungry and thirsty people, I'd say. And there's a lot of beautiful people, beautiful women and guys and dudes having good times all together. It's a big event, like I said, it's a day out for the bartenders actually, because these are all bartenders and chefs and could be even receptionists.

And I saw one girl over there earlier, I think she works in a nice hotel. There's a lot of non-alcohol options down there. Now you work in a bar and you gave up drinking for quite a while, because as we know, if you work in bars, you can get pulled into this drinking culture.

Well, you're right, and I stopped drinking almost several years ago. Heineken 0.0 and for instance Warsteiner 0.0 and many other brands doing the right thing. They're doing it for themselves, because they can still sponsor sports events they were banned off.

But then again, the money, they have the money to complete this industry for the thirsty guy who still have to drive or maybe have a small issue with his health. So I think it's a good thing. Like also people going, you know, you don't have to eat meat all the time.

And they have like Beyond Meat and other brands, so many, who are actually doing a really good job. So you can try once a week, have a phony burger, but it's really good. Do it.

Yeah. Well, you're just tasting the Beyond Meat brand before, and they're going into Woolworths in Australia, which is one of our big supermarket chains. And Beyond Meat is, it's incredibly realistic.

You really can't tell the difference now. Sausage, that burger, that chicken bits, it's all there. So yeah, so innovation in this industry is important.

And the thing is, it's there, it's right here, and it's happening. It makes me happy in a funny way. Yeah.

Yeah. We've all got to be a bit more healthy. And especially the young people these days, they're not drinking as much.

They're not getting wiped out as they used to be, which is a good thing. In the Netherlands, it used to be like drinking at 16, they raised it to 18. I don't think it really helps because they're going to drink at home, whatever.

But you know, smoking is not that good for you. Drinking from a very young age, you can wait a little bit, you can drink the rest of your life. You know, look at me, I drink 30 years straight, a little bit too much.

And that got me on heart pills. So there you have it. Yeah.

Now you've been in the hospitality industry for many years. You run a fantastic bar called the Excalibur Bar, which is right in the Red Light District. Tell us a bit about that.

Well, it's a bar in the center of Red Light District, as you mentioned, Excalibur Cafe Amsterdam, find it on Facebook and Instagram. I worked there for 30 years. I met almost the whole world in there, from generals, to actors, to porn stars, to politicians, movie stars, you name it.

Yeah, I've seen a bit of funny things in my time. And the good thing is, because you're not drinking anymore, you can see things a lot more clearly. I noticed, I bet it was, I bet it was fun.

But Heineken have this new glass that when they serve a zero-zero drink, you can get in a proper Heineken glass. It's just got a blue label on it now. Tell us about that.

Well, I saw that today, but it's not mandatory to use them. But if they have on draft also a Heineken zero and they have a proper glass, but instead of the green classic label, they put it in blue and it says zero-zero for you. I don't know what it says for you, but that helps you don't grab the wrong glass and still drive away.

Exactly. And that's what it's all about these days, having a great time and being able to drive home properly and get in trouble with the law and all that sort of thing and still have a great night out. That's what it's all about, really.

First of all, the website and you have your own blog. I mean, you're a bit of a star here in the Netherlands because you have your own video system. Tell us a bit about that.

Well, I can always use more subscribers and I'm growing a channel. It's called Channel Zero by Z. Yeah. And I travel a little bit Thailand.

I was in Hong Kong recently. I do visit other bars. I have video around the city to the beaches of the Netherlands, Germany.

Anywhere I go, I bring my camera. I do a little report or vlog. Sometimes they're all different.

Sometimes they're similar. But I like to do it. I started doing that.

We'll keep it real short. But the lockdown hurt us all a couple of years ago, 2020, and the bars were closed. So that's my business and I had nothing else to do.

And it's taken off. You're getting lots and lots of thousands of people following you now. True.

Correct, actually. So yeah, just subscribe. More subscribers, welcome.

I have more content laying around to be edited. I promise it will be more content soon. Zad, thanks so much for giving you this overview of Horacava here in Amsterdam in the Netherlands.

And if anyone is traveling here and they're in the hospitality industry, it's easy to register and they can come along and have a look. I did, actually. For the Horacava? Yeah.

Well, the main entrance to help you out, there's the reception lady over there, pretty lady. She will help you out and help you get tickets. No problem at all.

Great. Thanks, Zad. And thanks for this overview of Horacava.

And thanks for being on Travel Radio Australia. And we hope to see you in Australia one day. Yeah, mate.

Thank you. See you, mate. Cheers, mate.